CoWIN had demonstrated that India had the capability to develop great scalable digital systems.

He noted that when we initially began to use the platform, several groups raised the issue of how the digital divide would be dealt with. The platform, he added, was fully capable of making on-the-spot registrations as well, for people who chose to walk into vaccination centres without prior appointments. By July, he said, over 80 per cent of Indians had been registered on the platform had gotten their vaccine doses without prior appointments. He proudly announced, 'I am proud to say the CoWIN is the fastest technology platform in the world.'[4]

In a later conversation, Sharma expressed how CoWIN could be repurposed post-pandemic to create a National Digital Health programme which could very quickly, within a couple of years, ensure that the entire country is connected through a grid that validates the identities of patients, healthcare providers, healthcare facilities and pharmacies. This would be an open and interoperable grid which would have the capability to leverage extensive internet connectivity and robust digital identities where Aadhaar would play a crucial part in plugging in gaps in the current healthcare delivery.

Eventually, CoWIN turned out to be a state-of-the art, top-class portal with sophisticated solutions which even several developed countries couldn't match. While countries like the UK and the US were issuing flimsy pieces of papers as vaccination records, we were issuing QR-coded vaccine certificates linked to Aadhaar numbers and available on WhatsApp and Digilocker on demand. The portal was also built in with some special features: people with disabilities didn't need to submit any documents at all apart from their unique disability registration number. If the vaccine certificate had errors, it could be corrected with just a click within 24 hours. To ensure that all vaccines administered came from legitimate, approved sources, a provision was added in the portal wherein slots at centres could be activated only once the vaccine manufacturer confirms supplies to that particular centre on the CoWIN portal. Also, doses would be auto calculated based on stock purchased versus used.

In September 2021, when the UK opened up travel to vaccinated Indians, it first announced that they would not recognize Covishield and Covaxin and would need Indian passengers to finish their quarantine requirements. After pushback from the Indian government on the lines that